STUDENT'S ACTIVITY

A young boy has a wound which is not healing. You need to make sure that his diet includes enough of one particular vitamin. Which vitamin is this and what foods will provide it?

DO YOU KNOW?

Very large doses of fat soluble vitamins if not eliminated from the body, become toxic. This is called as 'Hypervitaminosis.'

V. Minerals

These are the inorganic compounds in micro quantities which are essential for many vital functions of the body. The minerals constituent of the body amounts to 4.3 to 4.4 %, largely in the skeleton.

General Functions of Minerals

As constituents of hard tissue. (eg.) calcium and phosphorus in bone and teeth.

As constituents of soft tissue. (eg.) Sulphur and phosphorus.

As constituents of substances assisting in the regulatory function of the body (eg.) salts in solutions influence nerve and muscle action.

Some of the essential mineral salts are sodium, potassium, calcium, phosphorus, magnesium, iron and iodine.

DO YOU KNOW?

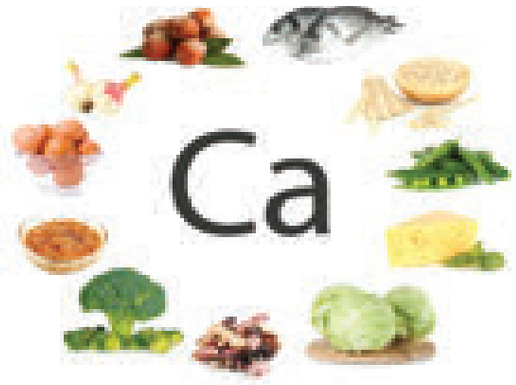
The body contains some 50 minerals.

Calcium

Calcium is most important for children and pregnant women.

Calcium is important component in bones and enamel of teeth. 99% of body calcium is found the bones.

Sources: milk and its products, green leafy vegetables, bones of meat, fish, pumpkin, coconut, dry fruits, cereals.



Daily requirements: 400- 500mgm

Functions

- Formation and maintenance of bones and teeth
- Coagulation (Thickening) of blood
- Muscle contraction

DO YOU KNOW?

- Milk is one of the best sources of calcium for the human body. Other sources are:
- Cereals and millets - Ragi
- Pulses and legumes - whole Bengal gram, whole horse gram, rajmah
- Nuts and oil seeds - mustard seeds, poppy seeds
- Green leafy vegetables - agathi, drumstick leaves
- Milk and milk products - cow's milk, buffalo's, milk, cheese, khoa
- Fish and sea food

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